

4 Hatherley Road

Kew Gardens.

7. v. 1919

Dear Sir -

Thank you for your letter : I have only just received my manuscript from the typewriter.

What I enclose is a preface and on reading it through again I see it wants rewriting : but you will be able to judge what I am driving at : I hope you will consent to read also chapter 1 when it is ready.

It is extraordinarily difficult to know how to write for any one who won't use symbols. When I bought your introduction to Mathematical Philosophy the bookseller hinted that I had better keep my halfguinea, for, he said Look here and here - and he pointed to various tit bits he had discovered which all seemed to me quite common sense - why the fellows mad ! And I can assure you that that opinion is shared by at least one mathematical master at Rugby ! If the public is to be converted, they must be got to understand. And I'm sure they can't understand your last volume. I want to become theoretically sound : and for that purpose I am working very hard at languages : I can now read eight European ones and am learning a ninth : I am also making slow headway with Russian, Persian and Japanese. The last, especially is going to be of immense help : I knew I was going

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to learn something as soon as I got a drift of the writing and understood that there is no article, that adjectives are conjugated and that a sentence is usually in the English order if you read it backwards. And I am preparing for understanding how and what the public understands by having accepted an offer from the Pelman Institute to join their staff of directors and write a new course for them. If ever I am in a position to give up all bread and butter work I shall devote three years to Mathematics : and then I shall have something to think about. In the meantime I hope you will make allowances for work produced by a wage earner with a family to feed at present prices !

Yours faithfully

W. V. BRIGSTOCKE.

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